Bende Var - Design Justification

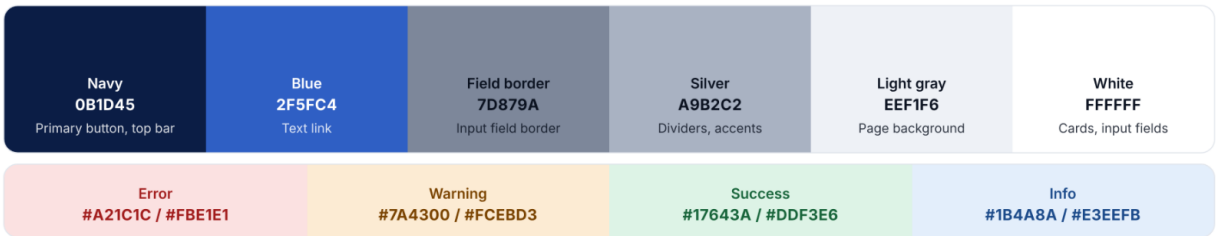
MTM4186 Mobile Programming - Milestone - Team 2

1. Users and Purpose

Buying a calculator just for one exam, one we normally never use, can be hard for students. Renting items from rental apps, on the other hand, can be risky in terms of safety. Borrowing from a member of a community we know and trust makes more sense, but there is no app for this on the market. So we wanted to build an app where students in the same school, dorm or community can help each other. A student posts a request, and someone who has the item helps by saying “Bende var!” (“I have it!”). That is why we focused on three things in the design: the app should feel trustworthy, be quick to use, and never be confusing.

2. Color Palette

Before starting the design, we looked at many shopping and second-hand apps. Choosing the color palette took a long time. First, we found combinations we liked on color palette websites and compared them in a group presentation. Pastel tones were eliminated because they looked too faded. We also ruled out palettes dominated by red or green, because we were going to use these colors for error and confirmation messages, and having them as the main color could cause confusion. We settled on blue because it is both trustworthy and calm. All that was left was adjusting the shade, and we chose our current main color because it is close to YTÜ’s navy blue.



Some rules we set when using the colors:

- We didn’t use silver for input field borders, because it is hard to see on a white background (contrast 2.1:1). For field borders we chose a slightly darker gray instead (#7D879A, 3.6:1).
- Text and icons on a navy background are always white. Blue text can’t be read on navy (2.8:1).
- Each screen has only one solid navy button, so the user can find the main action right away.
- We used red only for error messages and for actions with serious consequences, such as “Leave” or “Unblock”. Wherever users see red, they know they need to be careful. We don’t show errors with color alone; we add an icon and a sentence that tells the user what to do, so someone who has trouble telling colors apart can still understand the problem.

3. Typography

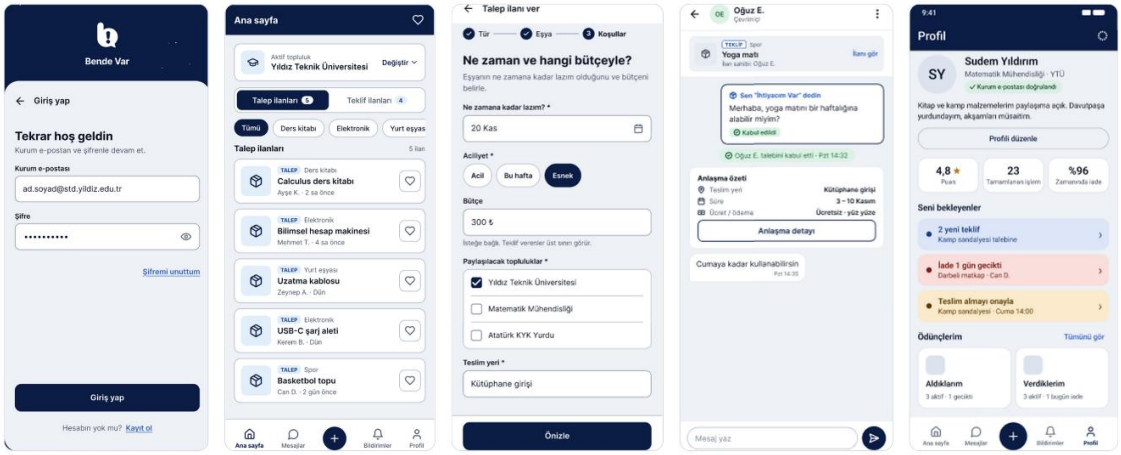
Navy is a trustworthy but serious color. Combined with an angular or very formal typeface, the app could have looked too cold, so we wanted to balance that seriousness with a simple, soft typeface. The typeface also had to display Turkish characters (ğ, ş, ı, İ) correctly. We tried Roboto, Poppins and Montserrat, and chose Inter instead. Inter is a clean typeface, it stays easy to read even at small sizes on a phone, and it is easy to add to Flutter.

We used only Inter throughout the app. We separated headings, body text and small descriptions by size and weight: screen titles are 22 px bold, body text is 15 px regular, and descriptions are 12–14 px. We never went below 10 px and kept line spacing generous. Consistency across the app and keeping it easy on the eyes were important to us.

Brand 28 / 34 · Bold	**Bende Var**
Heading 1 22 / 28 · Bold	**Welcome back**
Heading 2 18 / 24 · Bold	**Verify your email first**
Top bar 16 / 22 · Semi Bold	**Notifications**
Body 15 / 22 · Regular	We'll let you know when someone says "I have it".
Body small 14 / 21 · Regular	Enter your institutional email and we'll send you a reset link.
Label 13 / 18 · Semi Bold	**Institutional email**
Caption 12 / 16 · Regular	Can't find the email? Check your spam folder too.
Section label 11 / 14 · Bold, uppercase	PRIVACY & SUPPORT

4. Layout and Components

We expected people to use the app mostly with one hand, while walking or between classes. So we arranged the screens to be comfortable to use with the thumb, and we applied the same rules across the whole team:



Log in
Eda Hacıoğlu

Home
Emine Nur Baldık

New request
Reşide Sena Gül

Chat
Elif Yanar

Profile
Berin Sudem Yıldırım

- The main button is at the bottom, where the thumb can reach. Main buttons are 52 px tall, and the smallest touch area is 48×48 dp.
- Each screen has a single main button, so users don't have to search for what to do next.
- Dialogs and pickers open from the bottom, so there's no need to reach for the top of the screen.
- Before actions like deleting, logging out or leaving a community, a confirmation dialog appears. In this dialog the highlighted button is "Cancel", so nothing is lost even if it's tapped by mistake.

5. Conclusion

While designing Bende Var, we always put ourselves in the user's shoes: a student looking for a calculator before an exam, whose iron just broke, who needs to find something in a hurry. That's why we built our decisions on color, typography and layout around trust, speed and simplicity. We set these rules together as a team and applied them the same way on every screen.